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PLAYAQ: DIGITAL HOME MAINTENANCE & REPAIR PLATFORM

GROUP: 03

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1.1 INTRODUCTION

In today's modern environment, maintaining essential household systems such as plumbing, electrical wiring, and air conditioning has become increasingly important. However, consumers frequently struggle to find reliable, certified and trustworthy repair professionals. This gap often leads directly to negative customer experiences, financial loss, wasted time and severe safety risks when unskilled or uncertified workers handle critical infrastructure.

To address these points, this project proposes **PLAYAQ**, a trusted and centralized digital platform designed to safely connect users with thoroughly vetted and certified service professionals. By transitioning outdated, unverified manual inquiry processes into a structured digital ecosystem, PLAYAQ provides peace of mind and guarantees customer satisfaction across the entire transaction lifecycle.

1.2 PROBLEM DESCRIPTION

1.2.1 Background of the Problem

Currently, consumers rely heavily on informal networks, localized walk-ins, personal word-of-mouth recommendations or online messaging groups (like WhatsApp) to source technician availability. Existing traditional solutions are heavily decentralized. At present, general users facing critical home emergencies often:

- Spend excessive time checking contractor availability manually across unverified channels.
- Lack any systematic method to screen technician background data or confirm active vocational certifications before granting entry into their homes.
- Receive highly volatile and inconsistent pricing frameworks from distinct unvetted sources, leading to a profound fear of hidden charges.

1.2.2 Problem Statement

The current manual home maintenance sourcing processes contain severe issues for consumers that PLAYAQ directly aims to address:

- **Inconsistent Billing Practices:** Users face high uncertainty regarding upfront pricing and are frequently overcharged upon job arrival.
- **Absence of Verified Trust and Safety:** There is no public marketplace platform to cross validate background checks, active trade licenses, or professional credentials.
- **Zero Transactional Accountability:** Traditional independent contractor engagements completely lack centralized platform-backed warranties or structured recourse mechanisms once a job is complete.
- **Scheduling and Resolution Friction:** Diagnosing complex technical repair requirements via standard phone menus is time-consuming and prone to human miscommunication.

1.3 PROJECT OBJECTIVE

- Build a searchable digital repository using Eloquent ORM where users can filter, evaluate, and view profiles of verified independent professionals across multiple service segments.
- Provide a transparent booking system with upfront pricing, quotations, and secure service records.
- Implement ratings, reviews, and warranty tracking to improve accountability and service quality.
- Create a professional dashboard for technicians to manage profiles, certifications, and job requests.
- Integrate an interactive assistant interface to help users identify repair issues and estimate costs before booking.

1.4 PROJECT SCOPE

1.4.1 Scope

User Authentication & Role Management: Dual-guard authentication (using Laravel Jetstream/Fortify or custom middleware) dividing the platform into separate **Customer** and **Professional Account** structures.

Customer Interface (Booking Lifecycle - CRUD):

- **Create:** Form wizard to file a repair request (selecting a category, providing a description, and uploading images/visual evidence of the issue).
- **Read:** Searching and side-by-side comparison of active, verified professional profiles (viewing hourly rates, specialized badges, and historical reviews).
- **Update/Delete:** Scheduling utility allowing clients to choose preferred time slots (e.g., Morning 8 AM - 12 PM) and modify or cancel bookings before validation.

Professional Portal (Dashboard Control):

- Business command center for contractors to track total earnings, update active service specialties, modify public bios, and upload proof of vocational certifications.

Secure Payment & Escrow Status Simulation:

- Financial transaction model tracking milestone processing: capturing a 30% deposit to secure booking, locking funds securely during fulfillment, and releasing remaining balances only upon explicit customer confirmation of satisfaction.

Review & Rating Pipeline:

- Post-job fulfillment interface requiring star ratings and text feedback inputs to instantly recalculate a provider's public reputation score.

1.4.2 Targeted User

The platform caters cleanly to two critical market segments:

- **Service Seekers:** Urban and subUrban homeowners, residential renters, busy families, and property managers requiring rapid, trusted technical repairs.
- **Service Providers:** Certified independent handymen, electricians, plumbers, and HVAC technicians who possess valid qualifications but lack modern digital marketing pipelines.

1.4.3 Specific Platform

The web application requires several components to support its deployment and execution:

- A responsive, desktop-optimized web application engineered using the Laravel MVC framework, leveraging Blade templates for dynamic views, and MySQL for relational database management.

1.5 CONSTRAINTS

Foreseen development and market challenges include:

- **Shariah-Compliance Restriction:** All featured categories, platform interactions, and advertised content must strictly maintain compliance with Islamic ethical and commercial guidelines.
- **Data Privacy Boundaries:** Secure storing of personal identification data and verification documents uploaded by contractors during background checks.
- **Simulated External Gateways:** Because this is an academic deployment, functional external API dependencies will be simulated using structured database lookups, hardcoded logic trees, and internal session variables.

1.6 PROJECT STAGES

Milestone	Estimated Completion Date	Description
Phase 1: Requirements & Proposal	24 May 2026	Finalizing problem framework, system specifications, and proposal submission.
Phase 2: System Design	27 May 2026	UI/UX mockups, wireframing, Database Schema (ERD), and MVC route mapping.
Phase 3: Core Implementation	2 June 2026	Front-end coding, backend Laravel controllers setup, and CRUD operations initialization.
Phase 4: Integration & Alerts	5 June 2026	Setting up real-time booking alerts, and implementing technician verification and rating modules.
Phase 5: Testing & Deployments	6 June 2026	Executing system functionality evaluations and compiling final project documentation.

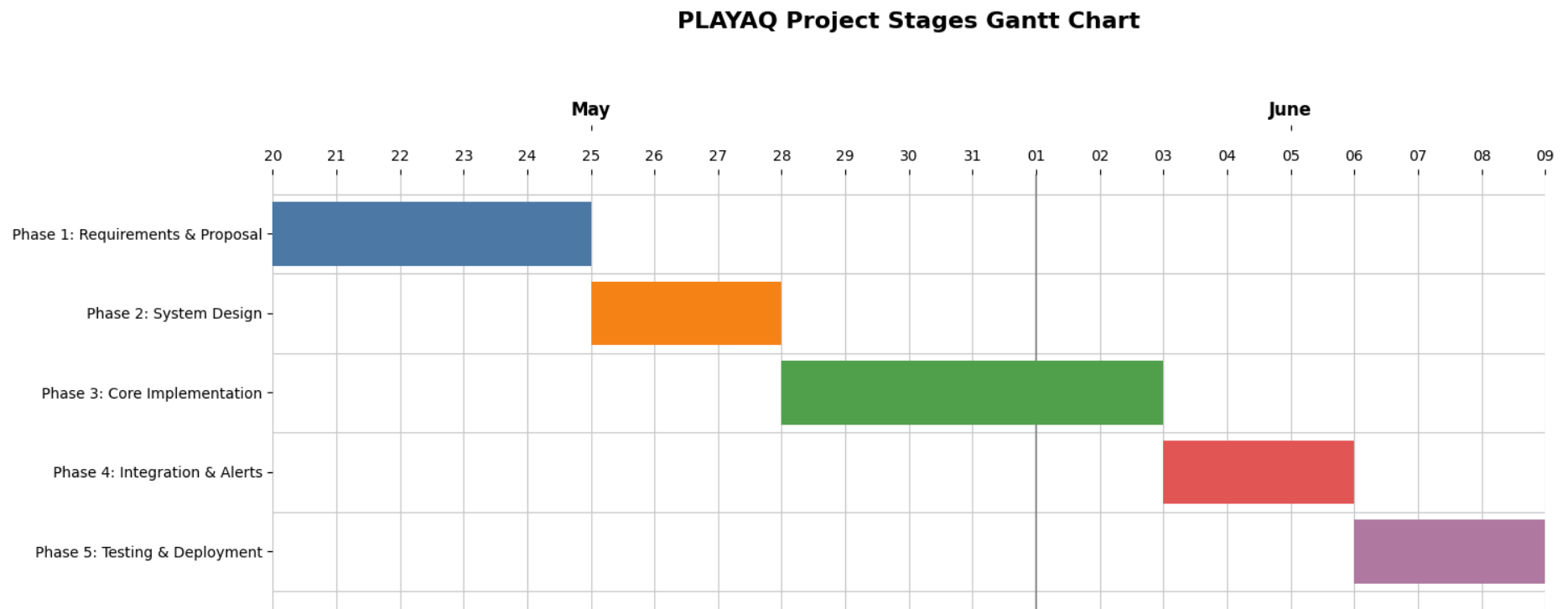


Figure 1: Gantt Chart Illustrating the PLAYAQ Project Development Stages

1.7 SIGNIFICANCE OF THE PROJECT

- **For the General Public:** Maximizes household productivity and personal convenience by replacing inefficient manual vetting loops with instantly accessible, verified pricing information.
- **For Skilled Workers:** Protects lower-income service professionals against the risk of non-payment or sudden last-minute customer cancellations through a fair, platform-backed deposit mechanism.
- **For local Ecosystems:** Optimizes overall community fuel footprints and travel congestion by matching technicians exclusively with repairs situated right within their target service radius.

1.8 SUMMARY

In summary, PLAYAQ steps into a highly fragmented marketplace to provide a digital framework for an industry still overly reliant on loose verbal agreements. By coordinating structural elements such as transparent visual quoting tools, mandatory trade validation badges and structured deposit payment protections, the platform shifts home repair tracking safely into modern parameters.

1.9 REFERENCES

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